resisting such a movement. I told him that my Prime Minister and I had made several statements that we had no interest in the internal affairs of Afghanistan and Balochistan.

Henry Kissinger: The Shah was not accusing India but only mentioned various possibilities.

Swaran Singh: He was mainly worried about Balochistan and indirectly about North West Frontier Province. I told him that we were not supporting any subversive movements there.

Henry Kissinger: The Shah told me that you had asked him if he would consult you before he gave any arms to Pakistan and he said to you that he would.

Swaran Singh: Yes, he said this to me.

This conversation reveals a very important point: the USA played the role of a mediator on certain vital issues and India's concerns were often transmitted to the Shah of Iran through the American government. Vipul said that a few other files clearly explained the hostility that began with Seyyed Abolhassan Banisadr, Iran's first president after the revolution. India's woes were compounded by Iraq's invasion of Iran in September 1980. The relationship turned worse after Ayatollah Khomeini appointed Ali Khamenei as president of Iran in 1981. The Americans believed that Khomeini's hatred towards nations considered to be supporters of the Shah had intensified after the US government gave refuge to the Shah, who had fled the country after revolutionary forces took over the capital city in 1979. Khomeini's protege President Khamenei had similar views.